them, they are intended for non-text fields like keywords, numericals, and dates. A term query still produces scores when invoked in the query context.

If you want to use a term query on a text field, be sure the text field is indexed like an enumeration or a constant. For example, an order status field with CREATED, CANCELLED, and FULFILLED states is a good candidate to use a term query even though it is a text field.

However, if text fields are populated with unstructured text like non-enumeration-styled values, we won't get the expected results when we run term queries. Let's check out an example of what happens when we run a term query on a text field.

### 9.2.2 Example term query

Let's see what happens if we search a text field called title using a term query. The following listing searches for "The Godfather" in the title of the movie using a term query. (Remember that in our movie mappings, the title field has an explicit text field mapping set.)

**Listing 9.2 Using a term-level query on a text field**

```
GET movies/_search
{
  "query": {
    "term": {
      "title": "The Godfather"
    }
  }
}
```

When we run this code, we receive *no* results (see figure 9.1). This is because the title field is a text field, so it underwent an analysis process and was stored in the index before the search. *The Godfather* was broken down and stored as lowercase tokens (because we are using the standard analyzer by default) in the inverted index: ["the", "godfather"]. A search query is not analyzed for term queries; instead, it takes each word as is and compares it against the inverted index. In this case, the query criterion "The Godfather" does not match the tokens ("the" and "godfather") for the title field.

Rerunning the query using "the godfather" also does not return any results (try running the query, lowercasing the title like this). The term query tries to match the exact value "the godfather", which is not in the inverted index (remember, the title was tokenized and stored as two words: "the" and "godfather"). However, searching for "godfather" returns results because the word *godfather* was analyzed and inserted into the inverted index during data indexing, and hence a match is found.

The takeaway is that we need to run term queries on non-text fields. If you want to use a term query to search a text field, be sure the text field contains data in the form of enumerations or constants.